

教學大綱 Syllabus

科目名稱：種族、宗教、民族主義：全球的暴力與歸屬政治

Course Name:

Ethnicity, Religion, Nationalism: Violence and the Politics of Belonging in the Global World

學年學期：115-1
Fall Semester, 2026

科目代碼：ZU1896001
Course No. ZU1896001

課程簡介

Course Description



修別：
選

Type of
Credit:
Elective

3.0

學分數
Credit(s)

18

預收人
數
Number
of
Students

課程資料

Course Details

開課單位：創國學三、創國學四

Course Department: Global Studies/B/3&4

授課老師：Deasy Rumondang Prisc

Instructor: Deasy Rumondang Priscilla

先修科目：無

Prerequisite(N/A)

上課時間：五D56

Session: fri13-16

Notes:

- **Essays:** Students write **1 essay (1000 words), due at the mid-term**. This essay is written in a style of policy commentary. For this essay, students choose for themselves at least 2 theories from the 16-week course, and a case study.
- **Final paper:** Students write **1 individual final paper (4,000-5,000 words) due at the end of the course**. Students choose the topic of these final papers themselves.
- **Presentations:** Students present twice: 1 on the weekly topic of their choice, 1 very short 5-minute presentation on the framework of their final papers.
- **The course includes stimulating activities such as debates, games, simulations, and watching a film. Film Title: Argo (2012), a three-Oscar-winning film about the rescue of US embassy employees from the siege of the American embassy in Tehran, Iran. Director: Ben Affleck. This film shows how Iran's religious nationalism and US secular nationalism clashed during the 1979 Iranian revolution.**
- Alternatively the course is planned to introduce **an innovative learning method which includes visits to religious civil society organizations to discuss with religious leaders/activists on the interplay between "religion"**

**and “nationalism”, the organizations
are: the Presbyterian Church in Taiwan
(PCT) or the Tzu-Chi Foundation.**

In light of the prolonged Israeli-Hamas war and the ongoing tensions between the United States and Iran, observers have warned of the possibility of a serious regional escalation and renewed global instability in the near future. The course “Ethnicity, Religion, Nationalism: Violence and the Politics of Belonging in the Global World” provides a structured space for students to critically examine how ethnic and religious identities shape nationalism and contribute to political conflict and violence in different regional and international contexts.

The course explores the interaction between religion and ethnic identities in Asia (East Asia, South Asia and Southeast Asia), the Middle East, and the United States, and their impact on the construction of nationalism. It addresses critical questions of identity and citizenship, inclusion and exclusion, emotional and symbolic attachments, and the linkage between local and global political dynamics. The course asks how ethnicity and religion shape political interaction, how ethnic and religious identities may aggravate conflict or strengthen cooperation, and how they are mobilized in processes of nation-building and political legitimation. It further examines how relevant dimensions such as sacralization and symbolic forms of legitimation may lead to conflict and violence.

The course is divided into two parts. The first part introduces key concepts of ethnicity, religion, identity, nation, and nationalism, and examines major theoretical explanations for the emergence and persistence of nationalism. The second part focuses on the political consequences of nationalism for belonging and identity, including religious nationalism, fundamentalism, and identity-based conflict,



through case studies from China, Myanmar, Thailand, Indonesia, India, Turkey, Israel, and the United States.

The course also considers the role of digital technologies and artificial intelligence in shaping contemporary identity politics and nationalist mobilisation. Social media platforms, algorithmic systems, and AI-generated content increasingly mediate the circulation of ethnic and religious narratives, often amplifying polarization and reshaping boundaries of inclusion and exclusion in the process.

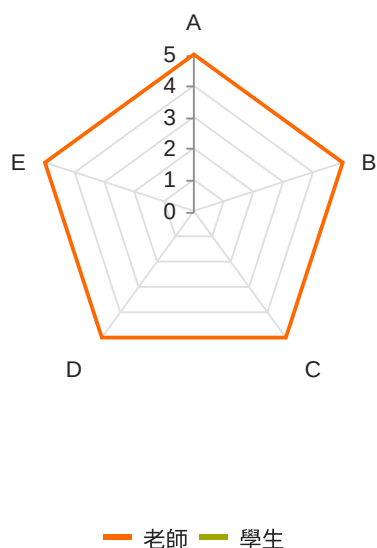
On Week 12 students will watch the film “Argo” (2012, Director: Ben Affleck), an Oscar-winning film which depicts the 1979 rescue of six U.S. State Department employees during the siege at the American embassy in Tehran, Iran.
Alternatively, the course will include an Innovative Learning Method Week with Study Visits to religious organizations. Planned visits include the Presbyterian Church in Taiwan (PCT), or Tzu-Chi Foundation, where students will engage with religious leaders and practitioners to discuss the interplay between “religion” and “nationalism”, and conflict.

核心能力分析圖



Core Competence Analysis Chart

雷達圖



能力項目說明

- A. 全球及區域研究之基礎智識
- B. 跨領域學習及研發之基礎知能
- C. 公民權利與基本權利之素養
- D. 全球及區域永續發展之專業
- E. 應用知識、有效溝通及參與審議之能力

課程目標與學習成效

Course Objectives & Learning

Outcomes

After completing the course, students will:

1. Understand the meaning of key concepts, such as ethnicity, religion, identity, nation, nationalism, religious nationalism and fundamentalism.
2. Understand the interaction and complex relations between these key concepts and their role in the politics of belonging and citizenship in various countries.
3. Understand the interaction and complex relations between these key concepts and their role in fundamentalism and/or political violence in various countries.
4. Be able to analyze current and/or past conflicts by examining how ethnicity and religion generate nationalism, which in turn may produce violence and political conflict in the global world.
5. Be able to critically assess how digital technologies and artificial intelligence (AI) shape the circulation, amplification, and contestation of ethnic, religious, and

nationalist narratives, and how these processes influence contemporary forms of identity politics and conflict.

課程屬性

Course Characteristics

級分說明 Score Description:

1關聯性最弱，2關聯性稍弱，3關聯性中等，4關聯性稍強，5關聯性最強。(1-5非百分比，而是Rank)
1 indicates weakest relevance, 2 indicates slightly weaker relevance, 3 indicates moderate relevance, 4 indicates slightly stronger relevance, and 5 indicates strongest relevance. (1-5 does not represent a certain percentage but indicates the rank).

課程屬性項目 Course Characteristics Items	級分 (1~5) Ranking	說明 Description
人文關懷課程 Humanity and Care Course	5	課程教學內容涉及學生人文關懷素養與態度之培養。 The course contents include the development of students' abilities and appreciation for humanistic care.
跨領域課程 Interdisciplinary Course	5	課程教學包含不同學門、領域之內容。 The courses include contents from different disciplines and fields.
社會參與課程 Social Engagement Course	5	課程教學內容涉及社會參與、服務等。 The course contents include social engagement and services.
總整課程 Capstone Course	4	係系統整與深化學生歷年所學，並運用於實務操作與討論，藉以檢視和評估學生的整體學習成效。 The courses are designed to integrate and intensify students' academic results from previous years and apply them in practice and discussions for the purpose of reviewing and evaluating the overall effectiveness of students' learning.
永續課程 SDGs	5	課程主軸明確探討永續性之統整概念及/或聯合國永續發展目標及/或「生態」與「社會/文化/經濟」系統之間的相互依賴性。關聯度級分請點選連結說明。 A unit of instruction that has a primary and explicit focus on the integrated concept of sustainability, and/or UN Sustainable Development Goals, and/or the interdependence of ecological and social/cultural/economic systems. Please refer to the link of relevance score.
資訊判讀課程 Information Literacy Course	5	課程內容旨在教授媒體、網路相關專業資訊之真偽辨別與判讀能力。 The course would provide skills to evaluate the quality of information found on the media and the Internet.



課程屬性項目 Course Characteristics Items	級分 (1~5) Ranking	說明 Description
AI 素養課程 AI Competence Course	5	將 AI 知能運用融入課程，引導師生與 AI 共學、協作，多元培養學生 AI 素養。 Integrate the application of AI knowledge into the curriculum, lead teachers and students to learn and collaborate with AI, and cultivate students' AI literacy.

每周課程進度與作業要求

Course Schedule & Requirements

Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
1	Introduction of concepts: religion, ethnicity, nationalism. 9/11	Syllabus Evaluation Criteria Class Regulations Required Readings Anderson, Benedict. 1991. <i>Imagined Communities: Reflections on the Origin and Spread of Nationalism</i> . London: Verso, pp. 5-7 Gellner, Ernest. 2006. Nations and Nationalism, pp.1-7. Additional Chandra, Kanchan. 2006. "What is ethnic identity and does it matter?" <i>Annual Review of Political Science</i> 9: 397-424.	• Introduction of syllabus and regulations • Lecture: Introduction of concepts • Students choose on which week they would like to do their weekly presentations. • No Homework



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
2	Civil versus Ethnic Nationalism 9/18	Required Readings Brubaker, Rogers. 2004. "'Civic' and 'ethnic' nationalism", in <i>Ethnicity without Groups</i>. Harvard: Harvard University Press. Chapter 6, pp. 132-146 Hutchinson, John and Anthony D. Smith (eds.). 1994. <i>Nationalism</i>. Oxford, UK: Oxford University Press, Introduction, pp. 3-5 Additional Fearon, James, and David D. Laitin, 2000, "Ordinary language and external validity: Specifying concepts in the study of ethnicity."	• Lecture: the congruence of ethnicity and nationalism • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates.
3	Moon Festival Holiday 9/25	No Class	No Class



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
4	Primordialism, Constructivism (and Digital Construction of Identity) 10/2	Required Readings Maxwell, A. (2020) Primordialism for Scholars Who Ought to Know Better: Anthony D. Smith's Critique of Modernization Theory. <i>Nationalities Papers</i>, 48(5): 826-842. Bayar, Murat. (2009) "Reconsidering primordialism: an alternative approach to the study of ethnicity." <i>Ethnic and racial studies</i> 32.9: 1639-1657. Additional Wang, Chia-Chou (2018) Primordialism, Instrumentalism, Constructivism: Factors Influencing Taiwanese People's Regime Acceptance of Mainland China's Government, <i>Journal of Contemporary China</i>, 27:109, 137-150 Noble, Safiya Umoja. "Algorithms of oppression: How search engines reinforce racism." <i>Algorithms of oppression</i>. New York university press, 2018.	• Lecture: ethnicity: is it a primordial or a constructed identity? • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates.
5	Deferred National Holiday 10/9	No Class	No Clas



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
6	Ethnic and Communal Violence: Rumours, Social Media and Mobilisation 10/16	Required Readings Brubaker, Rogers and David D. Laitin. 1998. "Ethnic and Nationalist Violence." <i>Annual Review of Sociology</i> 24:423-52 Additional Horowitz, Donald. 1985. <i>Ethnic Groups in Conflict</i>. Berkeley and Los Angeles: University of California Press, pp. 21-54 Karsten Müller, Carlo Schwarz. 2021. "Fanning the Flames of Hate: Social Media and Hate Crime", <i>Journal of the European Economic Association</i>, Volume 19, Issue 4: 2131–2167	• Lecture: how ethnicity leads to violence • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates.
7	Religious Nationalism 10/23	Required Readings Juergensmeyer, Mark. (2010) "The global rise of religious nationalism." <i>Australian Journal of International Affairs</i> 64.3: 262-273. Grzymala-Busse, Anna. (2019). Religious nationalism and religious influence. In <i>Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Politics</i> Additional Brubaker, Rogers. (2012). Religion and nationalism: Four approaches. <i>Nations and nationalism</i>, 18(1), 2-20.	• Lecture: introduction on how religion can evoke nationalist sentiments • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates.



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
8	Religious Nationalism and Fundamentalism 10/30 Midterm Essay Submission	Required Readings Emerson, Michael O., and David Hartman. (2006) "The rise of religious fundamentalism." <i>Annual review of Sociology</i> (2006): 127-144. Friedland, Roger. "Religious nationalism and the problem of collective representation." <i>Annual Review of Sociology</i> (2001): 125-152. Additional Juergensmeyer, Mark (1993) Why religious nationalists are not fundamentalists, <i>Religion</i> , 23:1, 85-92 Midterm Essay Submission	• Students submit their Mid-Term Essay (1,000 words) Essays are based on at least two theories that they have learnt in the class, and a relevant case study. The usage of other additional theories is encouraged. • Lecture: introduction on how religion can evoke nationalist sentiments • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates.
9	Ethno-religious Violence and Digital Mobilisation 11/6	Required Readings Mitchell, Claire (2006). The Religious Content of Ethnic Identities. <i>Sociology</i> , 40(6), 1135–1152 Gorski, Philip S., and Gülay Türkmen-Derviřođlu. "Religion, nationalism, and violence: An integrated approach." <i>Annual Review of Sociology</i> 39 (2013): 193-210. Additional Brubaker, Rogers. (2015), "Religious dimensions of political conflict and violence." <i>Sociological Theory</i> 33.1: 1-19.	• Lecture: how ethnicity and religion reinforce nationalism. • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
10	Ethnoreligious Conflict, Religious Nationalism, and Digital Mobilisation in Indonesia 11/13	Required Readings Menchik, J. (2014). Productive intolerance: Godly nationalism in Indonesia. <i>Comparative Studies in Society and History</i>, 56(3), 591–621 Simandjuntak, Deasy (2021) "Disciplining the Accepted and Amputating the Deviants: Religious Nationalism and Segregated Citizenship in Indonesia." <i>Asian Journal of Law and Society</i> 8.1: 88-107 Additional Aspinall, Edward (2008) Ethnic and religious violence in Indonesia: a review essay, <i>Australian Journal of International Affairs</i>, 62(4): 558-572	• Lecture: how Islamic nationalism is connected to electoral politics in Indonesia • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
11	Nationalism and Authoritarianism: Comparing Iran and Turkey 11/20	Required Readings Marashi, Afshin. "Paradigms of Iranian Nationalism: History, Theory, and Historiography." <i>Rethinking Iranian nationalism and modernity</i>. University of Texas Press, 2021. 3-24. Skocpol, Theda. "Rentier state and Shi'a Islam in the Iranian revolution." <i>Theory and society</i> 11.3 (1982): 265-283. Findley, Carter Vaughn. "Turkey, Islam, nationalism, and modernity." <i>Turkey, Islam, Nationalism, and Modernity</i>. Yale University Press, 2010. Additional Matin-Asgari, Afshin. "The Berlin circle: Iranian nationalism meets German countermodernity." <i>Rethinking Iranian nationalism and modernity</i>. University of Texas Press, 2021. 49-66.	• Lecture: the similarities and differences of modernity and religious nationalism in Iran and Turkey • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates • Final Presentation Batch 1



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
12	FILM WEEK Or Innovative Learning Week: Study Visit to Religious Organization 11/27	We will be watching Argo (2012) Director: Ben Affleck. One of the most high-profile film in 2012, <i>Argo</i> tells the story of six U.S. State Department employees who managed to escape the 1979 siege at the American embassy in Tehran (which resulted in the 444-day hostage saga), but who were still trapped in Iran. Alternatively, a study visit to The Presbyterian Church in Taiwan (PCT) General Assembly or Tzu-Chi Foundation (if today is dedicated to Study Visit, then the film watching ARGO (2012) will be arranged on an alternative day, or online, but still together, so we can afterwards discuss the film).	• Watch Film and Discussion Or • Meet with religious scholars • Discuss the interplay between “religion” and “nationalism”, and conflict



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
13	Ethnoreligious and religious nationalism in Myanmar and Thailand, with a comparison of how religions are practiced in Chinese societies. 12/4	Required Readings Kyaw, Nyi Nyi. "The role of myth in anti-muslim buddhist nationalism in Myanmar." <i>Buddhist-Muslim Relations in a Theravada World</i>. Palgrave Macmillan, Singapore, 2020. 197-226. Tonsakulrungruang, Khemthong. "The Revival of Buddhist Nationalism in Thailand and Its Adverse Impact on Religious Freedom." <i>Asian Journal of Law and Society</i> 8.1 (2021): 72-87. Kuo, Cheng-tian. "Religion, state, and religious nationalism in Chinese societies." <i>Religion and Nationalism in Chinese Societies, edited by Cheng-tian Kuo</i>. Amsterdam: Amsterdam University Press (2018). Ch.1 Additional Chowdhury, Arnab Roy (2020) "An 'un-imagined community': the entangled genealogy of an exclusivist nationalism in Myanmar and the Rohingya refugee crisis", <i>Social Identities</i> 26:5, 590-607	• Lecture: Comparing Buddhist nationalism in Myanmar and Thailand • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates • Final Presentation batch 2



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
14	Comparative Religious Nationalism in India and Israel: Media, Technology, and Identity Politics 12/11	Required Readings Van der Veer, P. (2021). Minority Rights and Hindu Nationalism in India. <i>Asian Journal of Law and Society</i>, 8(1), 44-55 Abiri, Gilad. (2021). Intimate Rivals: The Freedom of Religious Nationalism. <i>Asian Journal of Law and Society</i>, 8(1), 19-43 Additional Chacko, Priya. (2019). Marketizing Hindutva: The state, society, and markets in Hindu nationalism. <i>Modern Asian Studies</i>, 53(2), 377-410 Udupa, Sahana. "Nationalism in the digital age: Fun as a metapractice of extreme speech." <i>International Journal of Communication</i> (2019): 3143-3163	• Lecture: comparing religious and nationalism in India and Israel: ethnicity, religion and territoriality • Presentation of the readings (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates • Final Presentations batch 3
15	Christian Nationalism in the United States. 12/18 Last Day for Final Presentations	Required Smith, Anthony D. "Culture, community and territory: the politics of ethnicity and nationalism." <i>International Affairs</i> 72.3 (1996): 445-458. Juergensmeyer, Mark. "Religious nationalism in a global world." <i>Religions</i> 10.2 (2019): 97.	• Lecture: concluding the course: is religious nationalism the most lethal kind of nationalism? • Discussion: US Christian nationalism • Presentation (for one or two students who chose to do the topic) • Other activities: games, simulation, debates • Final Presentations batch 4



Week	Topic	Content and Reading Assignment	Teaching Activities and Homework
16	Constitution Day Holiday 12/25	No Class Final Papers are due on 4 January 2027	No Class

授課方式

Teaching Approach

30%

講述
Lecture

25%

討論
Discussion

30%

小組
活動
Group
activity

10%

數位
學習
E-
learning

5%

其他：
Others:

評量工具與策略、評分標準成效

Evaluation Criteria

Evaluations

- Attendance and active participation : 15%
- 2 Presentations (1 on week topic, 1 on final) : 30%
- 1 Essay : 25%
- 1 Final paper : 30%

Criterion

- **Attendance and active participation:** quality and frequency of contribution to class discussions and intervention. Excellence is marked by continuous contributions to class discussions and interventions which show high levels of analysis. Students should complete the assigned readings prior to the meetings and therefore are prepared to discuss the readings.
- **Presentations: Students present twice: the first one is on the essay topic of their choice; the second one is a short 5-minute presentation on the outline of their final paper.** Evaluation is based on the quality of argument, evidence of research, presentation structure and cohesiveness, speech flow and quality of oral delivery. Excellence is marked by structured delivery, clear and analytical argument, fluent speech, and use of PowerPoint or other tools. The short final presentation can be done within the last four lecture weeks of the course (thus, starting on week 11).



- **Essay at mid-term: The essay is 1,000 words long.**

Students choose at least 2 theories and a case study on which they would like to write essays. Students apply these theories on a case study, thus the essay is not only a summary of the readings. The essays are submitted on mid-term.

- **Final paper: The final paper is 4,000-5,000 words,**

focusing on a case study which is analyzed using the theories and concepts learned in the class. Students should consult the instructor about the topics at least four weeks before the paper is due. Evaluation is based on the quality and structure of the written piece, evidence-based and conceptually grounded argument, and adequate literature review. The usage of relevant additional materials not listed in this syllabus is encouraged. Excellence is marked by analytical argument, usage of relevant theories and concepts, understanding of current events, well-argued position.

Please see the Course Schedule above.

指定/參考書目

Textbook & References

已申請之圖書館指定參考書目

本課程可否使用 生成式AI工具

Course Policies on the Use of

Generative AI Tools

有條件開放使用: AI tools are permitted ONLY for limited parts of a learning task, such as grammar check and assisting with practicing foundational concepts. Students are NOT to rely on it for the entire assignment. Presentations and written tasks are made by students based on the reading materials, thus not by AI. Critical understanding of political theories and detailed nuances individual countries' politics derive from human interaction in the classroom. The professor seeks to ensure that students develop the critical knowledge,



problem-solving, and creative skills that are needed to pass this course. Plagiarism is a serious violation and will not be tolerated.

Conditional Permitted to Use

課程相關連結

Course Related Links

NA



課程附件

Course Attachments

課程進行中，使用智慧型手機、平板等隨身設備

To Use Smart Devices During the Class

需經教師同意始得使用

Approval

授課教師Office Hours及地點

Office Hours & Office Location

Thursdays and Fridays, upon appointment through emails deasysim3@gmail.com or deasysim@nccu.edu.tw

To be announced.

教學助理基本資料

Teaching Assistant Information

